

LeaveDesk

A web app for small companies to manage employee leave requests and daily attendance. Employees apply for leave online, managers approve or reject it, and HR gets automated attendance reports — replacing WhatsApp and Excel.

Leave Requests

Approval Workflow

Daily Attendance

Automated Reports

HR for Small Teams

1. Project Overview

LeaveDesk is a lightweight HR tool that gives small companies a proper system for leave and attendance — without the cost or complexity of enterprise HR software. Employees apply for leave through a simple online form, their manager approves or rejects it with a click, and HR receives clean, automated attendance reports. It replaces the messy mix of WhatsApp messages and Excel sheets most small teams rely on with one organized, trackable workflow.

Before — WhatsApp & Excel

- Leave asked for in chat, easily missed
- No record of approvals
- Attendance typed into spreadsheets by hand
- Balances tracked (badly) in someone's head
- Reports built manually every month

After — LeaveDesk

- Leave applied for & logged online
- Every approval recorded with a trail
- Attendance captured daily, automatically
- Balances calculated in real time
- Reports generated for HR on schedule

Problem it solves

- Leave requests get lost in chat with no formal record or approval trail.
- Attendance lives in error-prone spreadsheets that HR maintains by hand.
- Leave balances are unclear and often disputed.
- Building monthly attendance reports is slow, manual work.

2. User Roles

Employee	Manager	HR / Admin
• Applies for leave online • Sees remaining leave balance • Marks daily attendance / check-in • Tracks request status • Views own attendance history	• Gets notified of requests • Approves or rejects with a note • Sees team calendar & who's off • Monitors team attendance • Avoids clashing absences	• Configures leave types & policies • Sets holidays & work schedule • Manages employees & departments • Receives automated reports • Exports payroll-ready attendance

3. Key Features

3.1 Online Leave Requests

- Employees apply with leave type, dates and reason in a simple form.

- Real-time balance check prevents applying for more than available.
- Half-day and multi-day requests supported.
- Status tracking: pending, approved, rejected.

3.2 Approval Workflow

- Managers are notified instantly and approve/reject in one click.
- Optional comments and multi-level approval (manager → HR).
- Every decision is timestamped and recorded for accountability.
- Employee is notified automatically of the outcome.

3.3 Daily Attendance

- Daily check-in/out or present/absent marking per employee.
- Approved leave auto-fills the attendance record as "on leave."
- Late/early flags against the configured work schedule.
- Holidays and weekends handled automatically.

3.4 Leave Balances & Policies

- HR defines leave types (annual, sick, casual) and yearly allocations.
- Balances accrue and deduct automatically as leave is taken.
- Carry-forward and policy rules per leave type.

3.5 Automated Reports for HR

- Scheduled monthly attendance and leave reports emailed to HR.
- Per-employee summaries: days present, absent, leave taken, late count.
- Export to Excel/PDF, payroll-ready.
- On-demand reports by date range, department or employee.

3.6 Dashboards & Calendar

- Team leave calendar showing who's off and when.
- Manager view of pending requests and today's attendance.
- HR overview of company-wide attendance health.

4. How It Works — End-to-End Flow

1

Setup

HR adds employees and departments, defines leave types & allocations, and sets the work schedule and holidays.

2

Apply

An employee submits a leave request online; the system checks their balance and records it as pending.

3

Approve

The manager is notified, reviews the request against the team calendar, and approves or rejects it with a note.

4

Update

On approval, the leave balance is deducted and the dates are marked "on leave" in the attendance record automatically.

5

Track attendance

Each working day, attendance is captured (check-in or present/absent); leave, holidays and late flags fill in automatically.

6

Report

On schedule, the system compiles attendance and leave into a report and emails it to HR — no manual spreadsheet work.

One source of truth: leave and attendance share the same records, so an approved leave day is never double-counted or missed. Balances, calendars and reports all read from the same data — eliminating the mismatches that plague chat-and-spreadsheet setups.

5. Technology Stack

A responsive web application with an approval workflow, scheduled reporting and exports, built on a lightweight, hosting-friendly stack.

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Backend framework	Laravel 11 (PHP 8.3)	Auth, leave workflow, attendance, balances, reports.
Frontend (reactive)	Livewire 3 + Alpine.js	Leave forms, approval screens, calendar, dashboards.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Clean, mobile-friendly UI for employees on the go.
Database	MySQL 8.0	Employees, leave types, requests, attendance, reports.
Notifications	Laravel Mail + optional WhatsApp/SMS	Request & approval alerts, report delivery.
Scheduling	Laravel Scheduler (cron)	Automated monthly reports & reminders.
Queue / jobs	Database queue via cron worker	Report generation & notification sending.
Reports / export	Laravel Excel + DomPDF	Excel & PDF attendance/leave reports.
Auth & roles	Laravel Breeze + role permissions	Employee, manager and HR/admin access.
Calendar	JS calendar (FullCalendar)	Team leave & attendance calendar views.
Hosting	cPanel shared hosting / VPS	Affordable deployment; ideal for small companies.

Data model (core entities)

Entity	Holds
Employee	Profile, department, manager, role, join date.
Department	Team grouping & reporting line.
LeaveType	Name, yearly allocation, rules, carry-forward.
LeaveRequest	Employee, type, dates, reason, status, approver.
LeaveBalance	Remaining days per type per employee.
Attendance	Per-day status, check-in/out, late flag.
Report	Generated summary, period, recipients.

6. Workflow Logic & Integrity

- **Balance enforcement:** requests are checked against available balance at apply time and again at approval, preventing over-booking.
- **Approval trail:** every request stores who approved/rejected it and when, giving HR a clear audit record.
- **Auto-linked attendance:** approved leave writes straight into the attendance record, so reports never miss or double-count a day.
- **Schedule-aware:** weekends, holidays and shift times are respected when marking attendance and flagging lateness.
- **Role-scoped access:** employees see only their own data; managers see their team; HR sees the company.

7. Delivery Phases

Phase	Scope
Phase 1 — Core	Employees, leave types & balances, online leave requests, manager approval workflow.
Phase 2 — Attendance	Daily attendance marking, auto-linked leave, holidays & late flags, team calendar.
Phase 3 — Reporting	Automated scheduled HR reports, Excel/PDF exports, dashboards.
Phase 4 — Scale	Multi-level approvals, WhatsApp/SMS alerts, biometric/geo check-in, payroll integration.

Summary: LeaveDesk replaces WhatsApp-and-Excel HR with one organized system — employees apply for leave online, managers approve with a full trail, attendance is captured daily and auto-linked to leave, and HR receives automated reports. Built on a Laravel + Livewire

stack with scheduled reporting and exports, it deploys affordably and is sized perfectly for small companies.